

Question:

A 65-year-old man with decompensated cirrhosis secondary to hepatitis C is brought to the emergency department with 2 episodes of massive hematemesis that started 2 hours ago. He is a liver transplant candidate. The blood pressure is 110/85 mm Hg in the supine position and 90/70 mm Hg after sitting for 3 minutes. The pulse is 110/min, the respirations are 22/min, and the temperature is 36.1°C (97.0°F). The physical examination shows spider angiomas, palmar erythema, and symmetric abdominal distension with positive shifting dullness. The lung and heart examination shows no abnormalities. Two large-bore intravenous lines are obtained. Saline (0.9%) is initiated. Laboratory tests are pending. The most important next step is to administer which of the following intravenous therapies? Answer Choices: A. Fresh frozen plasma B. Octreotide C. Packed red blood cells (RBCs) D. Pantoprazole

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>considering the recent bleeding episodes and the possibility of portal hypertension and the patient's cirrhotic status</think><answer>octreotide</answer>

